Combat rule – Shoving · SRD 5.2.1

By replacing an attack with an **Unarmed Strike** (**Shove** option), you try to **push** or **knock down** a creature. The target rolls a **Strength or Dexterity** save, DC **8 + Str + proficiency**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Replaces **one attack**.
2. Target: at most **one size larger**.
3. **Str or Dex** save, DC **8 + Str + proficiency**.
4. Fail: **pushed 5 ft** or **knocked Prone**.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 folds the Shove into the Unarmed Strike and adds the **Push** and **Topple** masteries.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say what happens if the target is pushed into a void. Fix: it falls normally, no save.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the shoulder into the breastplate, the floor slipping from under the foe.

Step 1 – Announce:

You replace one attack with a Shove.

Step 2 – Size:

The target is at most one size larger than you.

Step 3 – Save:

Strength or Dexterity (target's choice), DC 8 + Str + proficiency.

Step 4 – Effect:

On a failure: pushed 5 ft straight away **or** knocked Prone.

Step 5 – After:

Standing up costs half your Speed; a melee attacker has advantage, a ranged one disadvantage.

Example: Léa (DC 14) shoves an ogre (one size larger): it fails its save and ends up Prone.

⚠ Common questions:

Maximum size?

One size larger than you.

What DC?

8 + Str + proficiency.

What save?

Strength or Dexterity, target's choice.

What distance?

5 ft, or Prone.

Effect of Prone?

Advantage in melee, disadvantage at range.

And the Push mastery?

It pushes 10 ft on a weapon hit (Large or smaller).

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Pushing into a trap

No save? **Option**: a new Dex save.

Target size

Can I exceed the limit? **Option**: no.

Willing ally

Can I push an ally? **Option**: no save.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Unarmed

The Shove is an Unarmed Strike.

No Opportunity Attack

Forced movement doesn't provoke one.

Masteries

Push and Topple come from weapons.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

Notices: This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.2.1 ("SRD 5.2.1") by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at https://www.dndbeyond.com/srd. The SRD 5.2.1 is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License, available at https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/legalcode. Unofficial sheet, 5E compatible (2024 rules), neither approved nor sponsored by Wizards of the Coast. Rules come from SRD 5.2.1; where the SRD gives no answer, explanations rely on our own interpretation. The "Table rule" parts are the author's own creations. Borders, banner, texture, titles, layout, table rules and examples: © Jaja, all rights reserved. Sources: SRD 5.2.1 (official English version); rule clarifications cross-checked with answers found on the web and reworded; numeric examples are invented; last revised: November 2026. Fonts: TeX Gyre Pagella (GUST), DejaVu Sans, Noto Color Emoji (OFL).